



SKOAR!

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Gears of War Judgment has managed to strike a rather delicate balance between what's familiar and what's new, making sure that the loyalists are not alienated and those choosing this game as the first in the franchise won't feel lost.

The Story: The story is revealed as the four members of Kilo Squad testify about the events that led them to stealing the top-secret COG technology, and hence, allows the user to step into each one of their shoes. For those wondering, yes, you do get to play as Sofia Hendrick, the foxy red-headed cadet from Onyx Guard Academy. This is the first time that players can play as several characters in the same game, as in the games that came before this one, you could only play as Marcus Fenix, the lead. The developers have done a really good job at pacing the story, making sure that it is cohesive and fun.

Gameplay: Gears of War Judgment lives up to the GoW lineage through and through. There is not a whole lot that's changed, but that which has, sticks out. For starters, you can only carry two weapons. On the bright side, it can be any two weapons, no more limited by "class." Many new weapons are introduced, but the Gnasher

Shotgun remains our absolute favourite. There's nothing quite so satisfying as watching a grub blow up into pieces from a single shot of this very powerful weapon. Tapping the Y key will switch your weapon instantly, which is much faster than the old D-pad method. The grenades are also a whole lot easier to toss (and trust us, you will be tossing them around a LOT).

The new game also boasts of a Smart Spawn System, which ensures that every time you respawn the enemy utilizes a new tactic to waste you. We couldn't wait to see if the claims were true, and we intentionally let our character die six times at various points in the game to see how the strategy would change. In many cases, the enemy would start their assault from a new position, taking full advantage of the vast landscape of the maps, but many a times, we were faced with different enemies altogether. This made the levels especially challenging, and kept us on our toes and those of you who love a good challenge, will be getting just that thanks to the Smart Spawn System.

Multiplayer: The Multiplayer aspect of the game is just as gratifying as the campaign, offering hours upon hours of relentless fun. The new OverRun mode is simply amazing, and shows that the developers are truly focused on delivering a unique gameplay experience. The mode is a class based mode, a first of its kind in the franchise, which does away with mindlessly running around killing each other in favour of a more objective based challenge. The OverRun mode epitomizes the importance

of team-work over everything else, so make sure you're on the right team. Along with that, there's also Domination, a new five versus five team-based competitive multiplayer mode. If you're the classic multiplayer enthusiast, fear not as Microsoft has retained the Free for All and Team Deathmatch modes as well, so that you can establish for good who's the boss. *

Verdict

GoW Judgment offers a very delicate mix between what we've come to love about the game and the series. It builds on the story of two very important characters who did not get their fair share of the limelight in the original trilogy and it does so in style. There's blood, there's glory and there sure as hell is a lot of profanity. The only thing disappointing about the game was that we felt it was over too quickly.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Epic Games
- » **Publisher:** Microsoft Studios
- » **Platform:** Xbox 360
- » **Price:** ₹2,999

